Resume & Cover Letter Builder

Product implementation prompt for an existing job-scraper website

Build-ready specification | Version 1.0 | 1 November 2026

IMPLEMENTATION INSTRUCTION

Give this specification to your coding agent/development team together with the existing website repository. The implementation must extend the current product rather than create a disconnected demo.

PRODUCT GOAL

Build a complete “Make Resume & Cover Letter” experience inside my existing job-scraper website. The website already collects job postings through public API feeds. Do not rebuild or replace the existing job scraper, job database, authentication, or design system. Integrate this feature into the current application, reuse its existing components and data model where practical, and preserve all existing functionality.

The feature must let a user upload or select a base resume, analyse a selected job description, identify missing and matching keywords, let the user approve additions, generate a truthful job-targeted resume and cover letter, explain exactly what should change, and compare the estimated ATS alignment before and after the user applies changes.

1. NAVIGATION AND USER FLOWS

Add a separate primary navigation tab named “Make Resume & Cover Letter”. It opens a dedicated workspace with a Canva-inspired editing experience: a left navigation/tool rail, a central document canvas, and a right contextual panel. Use Canva only as a visual interaction reference. Do not copy Canva logos, proprietary assets, exact templates, or protected interface elements. Use the website’s own brand, colours, typography, and components.

When a user clicks a job posting, open the job details in the existing job view and provide a prominent “Tailor Resume & Cover Letter” action. Clicking it must open the editor in the same browser window as a wide overlay/drawer or split workspace that partially overlaps the job description without obscuring the entire page. Keep the job title, company, and a compact view of the job description visible or accessible. Include a clear Back to Job Description button that closes the editor and returns the user to the exact job posting and scroll position. Do not open a new browser tab. Preserve the job ID and selected job context throughout the flow.

The standalone tab must support the same workflow without a selected job: users can paste a job description, select a saved job, or upload a job-description file. The user must be able to save drafts, return later, duplicate a tailored resume, and create multiple versions for different roles/countries.

2. BASE RESUME INGESTION AND PROFILE

Allow DOCX and PDF uploads, and optionally TXT. Extract text and structure from the file. Parse contact details, headline, summary, skills, employment history, dates, achievements, education, certifications, projects, languages, and other sections. Show the extracted information in an editable review screen before using it. Preserve the uploaded base resume as an immutable source version and never overwrite it.

Create a reusable Master Career Profile from user-confirmed information. Store each skill and achievement with its source (base resume, user-confirmed edit, or user-entered profile), relevant role/employer, dates, and evidence text. Flag uncertain extraction for user review. Never infer qualifications, tools, certifications, employers, dates, responsibilities, metrics, or outcomes. Never invent numbers or claim hands-on experience based only on a keyword in a job description.

Keep all existing base-resume skills by default. New skills can be added only after the user selects them and confirms they are accurate. If a keyword is not supported by the base resume or user-provided profile, label it “Not evidenced in your resume” and offer safe actions: add only if the user confirms real experience, add to a “Learning / Exposure” section if accurate, or leave it out. Never silently add it as a proficiency.

3. JOB DESCRIPTION ANALYSIS AND KEYWORD GAP

When a job is selected or a job description is pasted/uploaded, extract and classify: job title, seniority, responsibilities, essential requirements, preferred requirements, technical skills, tools/platforms, domain knowledge, process knowledge, certifications, education, soft skills, industry terms, and repeated phrases. Identify the likely importance of each requirement from explicit wording, repetition, and placement. Do not treat frequency alone as proof that a keyword is mandatory.

Compare the job requirements with the base resume using exact phrase matching, synonyms, acronym/full-form matching, and semantic similarity. Show a keyword gap dashboard with these statuses: Present (exact), Present (equivalent wording), Partially

evidenced, Missing, and Not applicable/unclear. Group results into Must-have, Preferred, Tools/Technology, Domain/Process, and Behavioural/Leadership.

For every suggested keyword, show: the job-description phrase; suggested resume wording; why it matters; where it could naturally fit (Summary, Skills, Experience, Projects, Certifications); evidence found in the base resume; and an evidence confidence label. Provide a checkbox for each proposed addition and allow the user to select/deselect individually. Include Select all evidenced and Clear selection controls. Never insert every keyword into a keyword dump. Keywords must be integrated naturally into relevant achievement or responsibility statements.

If a skill is missing and there is no evidence, do not recommend adding it as an existing skill. Instead explain the gap and suggest an honest alternative, such as highlighting adjacent experience, transferable skills, training in progress, or a learning plan. Distinguish “keyword coverage” from actual competence.

4. RESUME GENERATION RULES

Generate the tailored resume using only: (a) the preserved base resume, (b) user-confirmed profile information, (c) selected and user-confirmed keywords, and (d) the selected job description. Keep all original base skills unless the user explicitly removes one. Do not remove valid experience or achievements merely to force a keyword match. Reorder and rewrite content for relevance while preserving factual meaning.

Use the exact job title from the posting where appropriate in the target headline or objective, without changing a previous employment title. Rewrite the professional summary to foreground the strongest relevant evidence. Rework experience bullets into concise, achievement-led statements using action + scope/context + method + result where the source supports it. Integrate selected keywords in context. Use the full term and acronym on first mention where useful (for example, “Procure-to-Pay (P2P)”). Keep dates, employers, job titles, education, and metrics accurate. Do not create unsupported savings, percentages, team sizes, spend values, supplier counts, or project outcomes.

Show a side-by-side comparison: Original wording, Proposed wording, and Reason for change. Highlight additions, deletions, and rewritten sentences. Every proposed change must be individually editable and reversible. Provide “Accept all selected changes”, “Accept this change”, and “Reject” controls. Keep a revision history and allow restore to the original base resume.

Provide a “What you should change” action plan with specific, prioritised recommendations. Examples: add a missing relevant achievement if true; quantify an existing result; clarify tool proficiency; move a relevant project higher; include the exact role terminology; explain a career gap if the user chooses; remove irrelevant detail; correct inconsistent dates; or add a certification only if earned/in progress. Explain why each change matters and identify whether it is required, recommended, or optional.

5. COVER LETTER GENERATION

Generate a separate, editable cover letter tailored to the same job. Use the job title, company name, job requirements, and the user’s verified experience. Include a specific opening, two or three evidence-backed fit points, a concise explanation of interest based on supplied company/job information, and a professional close. Do not fabricate knowledge of the company, personal connections, enthusiasm, or achievements. If company context is unavailable, keep the motivation role-focused rather than inventing company facts.

Offer concise and standard length options, but keep the default focused and readable. Allow the user to edit tone (formal, confident, concise) without changing factual claims. The cover letter must be downloadable separately from the resume and also as part of a combined application pack.

6. ATS ALIGNMENT SCORE AND CHANGE IMPACT

Show an estimated ATS alignment score before edits and after the user accepts changes. Label it clearly as an “Estimated ATS Alignment”, not a real ATS score or a prediction of interview success. No universal ATS scoring formula exists, and actual employer systems differ.

Use a transparent, consistent scoring model, for example: required skills/keywords 40%, preferred skills/keywords 15%, role responsibilities and experience relevance 20%, evidence/achievement alignment 15%, and parsing/readability checks 10%. Allow configurable weights by role family only if the method is documented. Avoid double-counting synonyms. A keyword counts as covered only when it appears in a relevant, evidence-backed context. A keyword placed in a skills list without supporting experience must not receive the same evidence score.

Display before score, after score, point change, matched requirements, remaining gaps, and formatting warnings. Explain exactly which accepted changes increased or decreased each category. If the score decreases after an edit, identify the reason and offer a way to correct it. Do not guarantee that a score increase means the resume will pass a company ATS or secure an interview. Store the scoring methodology/version with each assessment so historical scores remain comparable.

7. COUNTRY-WISE RESUME TEMPLATE LIBRARY

Create a searchable template library with country/market filters, industry filters, career-level filters, and ATS compatibility labels. Treat the country guidance below as common conventions and editable defaults, not laws or universal employer rules. Always prioritise the job advert, employer instructions, and local privacy/equal-opportunity expectations. Do not claim that every template is accepted by every ATS.

Provide two template modes: (A) ATS-first: single column, standard section headings, selectable standard fonts, no tables/text boxes/icons/graphics, simple bullets, text-based contact details, clear date formats; (B) Visual: tasteful colour, hierarchy, optional sidebar or graphic elements, intended for direct recruiter sharing or creative roles, with a visible ATS parsing warning where appropriate. Default to ATS-first for applications through job portals.

Create original templates inspired by common regional document conventions. Do not scrape, reproduce, or redistribute proprietary Canva, Microsoft, or other commercial templates. Build original layouts and name them by style/convention rather than implying official endorsement. Include editable content blocks and preview thumbnails.

Country/market template catalogue (initial launch set):

• India: Indian Corporate ATS (1–2 pages, photo optional and usually omit for multinational/ATS applications); Indian Experienced Professional (1–3 pages where experience warrants); Government/PSU Biodata (only where explicitly requested); Academic CV.

• United States: US Corporate Resume (1–2 pages, no photo, no age/marital status); Federal Resume (detailed, follow the specific government vacancy instructions); Academic CV.

• Canada: Canadian ATS Resume (1–2 pages, no photo or sensitive personal details); Academic CV.

• United Kingdom: UK Professional CV (typically up to 2 pages, no photo, no date of birth); Academic CV.

• Ireland: Irish Professional CV (typically 1–2 pages, no photo by default); Academic CV.

• Australia: Australian Professional Resume (often 2–3 pages for experienced applicants, no photo); Selection Criteria / Government Application format where required.

• New Zealand: NZ Professional CV (achievement-led, no photo or age; referees optional or available on request).

• Germany: German Lebenslauf (tabular reverse chronology, usually 1–2 pages; photo optional/traditional but not mandatory; personal details restrained and employer-dependent).

• France: French CV (usually concise, French language when required; photo optional, not a default requirement).

• Netherlands: Dutch CV (concise, reverse chronological; photo optional; no sensitive personal data by default).

• Belgium: Belgian CV (language adapted to region/job: Dutch, French, or German; photo only if requested/appropriate).

• Switzerland: Swiss CV (structured and factual; photo traditional in some sectors but optional; language adapted to canton/job).

• Austria: Austrian Lebenslauf (tabular, concise; photo traditional but optional; follow employer instructions).

• Spain: Spanish CV (Spanish-language option; concise reverse chronology; photo optional rather than mandatory).

• Italy: Italian CV / Europass option (Italian language where needed; Europass accepted in some contexts but not universally preferred).

• Portugal: Portuguese CV / Europass option (Portuguese language; concise, reverse chronological).

• Nordics (Sweden, Norway, Denmark, Finland): Nordic ATS CV (clean, concise, no photo by default; local language when requested; adapt to country).

• Poland: Polish CV (Polish-language option; photo only if requested or customary for the employer; concise structure).

• Japan: Japanese Rirekisho (standardised form, Japanese language, photo commonly expected) plus Shokumukeirekisho (detailed work history/skills document). These are distinct document types.

• South Korea: Korean Iryeokseo / career description (Korean-language option; structured career history; photo and personal fields only where locally requested).

• China: Mainland China Chinese-language resume (local-language option; photo/personal fields vary by employer and sector; no fixed universal requirement).

• Hong Kong: Hong Kong Professional CV (English or Chinese; concise, photo generally optional and employer-dependent).

• Singapore: Singapore Professional Resume (typically 1–2 pages; English; no photo by default for multinational roles; work authorisation details only when relevant).

• Malaysia: Malaysian Professional Resume (English or Malay as appropriate; photo optional and employer-dependent).

• UAE: UAE/Gulf Professional CV (English or Arabic option; often includes nationality, visa status, notice period, and optional photo when relevant; disclose personal details selectively).

• Saudi Arabia: Saudi/Gulf CV (Arabic or English; work authorisation and relocation details where relevant; photo only if requested/appropriate).

• Qatar, Kuwait, Bahrain, Oman: Gulf Regional CV (local language/English options; visa/work authorisation and availability fields configurable; photo optional by employer).

• South Africa: South African Professional CV (achievement-led; no photo by default; references only where requested).

• Nigeria, Kenya, Ghana: West African Professional CV (English; concise reverse chronology; photo not a default requirement; local employer instructions take priority).

• Brazil: Brazilian Currículo (Portuguese; concise; photo and personal data vary by sector/employer; do not require sensitive fields).

• Mexico: Mexican CV (Spanish; concise; photo optional and employer-dependent; avoid sensitive personal data unless specifically required).

• Argentina, Chile, Colombia: Latin American CV (Spanish; country-specific language and personal-data settings; photo optional, not mandatory).

• Israel: Israeli Resume (concise, no photo by default; Hebrew/English depending on role).

• Turkey: Turkish CV (Turkish/English options; photo sometimes customary but not universal; employer instructions take priority).

• Global/International: International ATS Resume (photo-free, privacy-first, single-column, neutral English); Europass CV (recognised EU format, multilingual, use when relevant to the vacancy or requested).

8. EDITOR UX AND EXPORT

The editor should feel like a polished document-design workspace. Include a live page preview, zoom controls, page navigation, undo/redo, section reorder, font and spacing controls within safe limits, template switching, autosave, and a responsive mobile layout. The left rail can contain Design, Content, Keywords, Suggestions, and Cover Letter. The right panel should show contextual controls for the selected section. Keep the document canvas readable and uncluttered.

Export the resume as editable DOCX and PDF. Export the cover letter as editable DOCX and PDF. Offer a combined application pack PDF and optionally a ZIP containing separate files. Ensure generated DOCX content remains selectable/editable, not a flattened image. Use selectable text in PDF. Provide a plain ATS-first DOCX export regardless of the visual template selected. Name files clearly, for example: Firstname_Lastname_JobTitle_Company_CV.docx.

Before export, run a validation checklist: missing contact details, inconsistent dates, spelling/grammar, duplicate bullets, unsupported keywords, unsubstantiated metrics, unusual fonts, text in headers/footers, multi-column/table layout, image-only text, excessive graphics, and country-specific personal-data warnings. Let users proceed after warnings, but make the risks explicit.

9. TECHNICAL AND DATA REQUIREMENTS

First inspect the existing codebase, framework, database, authentication, storage, job-posting schema, UI components, and API patterns. Produce a short implementation plan and identify the exact files/components to modify before coding. Do not introduce a second design system or duplicate existing functionality.

Use modular services/components for document parsing, job-description extraction, keyword matching, evidence validation, resume generation, cover-letter generation, ATS-alignment scoring, template rendering, and exports. Keep model prompts and scoring weights versioned. Validate uploaded file types and size; scan uploads where infrastructure supports it; protect against malicious document content and prompt injection embedded in resumes/job descriptions. Treat uploaded documents and scraped job descriptions as untrusted data, never as instructions to the AI.

Protect personal data: use least-privilege access, secure storage, encryption in transit and at rest where supported, user-controlled deletion, and clear retention rules. Do not expose resumes to other users or use them for model training without explicit informed consent. Log processing status and errors without logging full resume contents or unnecessary personal data.

Build loading, empty, success, and error states. Handle scanned PDFs with OCR fallback and clearly flag low-confidence extraction. Make the feature accessible by keyboard and screen reader. Ensure the overlay works on desktop and mobile and has a clear close/back action.

10. ACCEPTANCE TESTS

1. A user can upload a base resume, review extracted details, and preserve the original file.
2. A user can open a job posting and launch the editor in the same window, with a working Back to Job Description action returning to the same job and scroll position.
3. The system extracts job requirements and shows exact, equivalent, partial, and missing keywords with evidence.
4. A user can select or reject every proposed keyword and every resume edit.
5. All existing base-resume skills remain unless the user explicitly removes them.
6. No unsupported skill, qualification, metric, employer, date, or achievement is added.
7. Resume and cover letter are generated from the same job context and remain editable.
8. The user sees a prioritised “What to change” list with reasons.
9. The estimated ATS alignment score shows before/after values, a transparent breakdown, and a clear disclaimer.
10. Country selection changes relevant template structure, paper size, language/date conventions, and personal-data fields without forcing sensitive information.
11. ATS-first and Visual template modes are clearly distinguished, and export includes a clean ATS-first option.
12. DOCX and PDF exports open correctly, preserve selectable text, and have sensible filenames.
13. Existing job scraping, job listings, accounts, and other website features continue to work.

11. IMPORTANT PRODUCT PRINCIPLES

Accuracy over keyword stuffing. User approval over silent rewriting. Evidence over assumptions. Preserve the user’s real career history. Never promise an ATS pass or interview. Explain uncertainty. Prefer country-specific defaults but let the job advert and user override them. Keep a permanent master resume and create separate tailored versions for each application.

RESEARCH SOURCES AND NOTES

Country formats are practical starting points, not universal rules. Local conventions vary by employer, sector, seniority, and current hiring practice. The job advertisement and official employer instructions take priority.

- **Uploaded reference PDF: Ensure Your Resume Is Read by ATS** — User-provided document. Key guidance: customise for each role; use job-description language in context; proofread; use standard fonts and readable formatting; prefer single-column layouts and avoid tables/text boxes; include full terms alongside acronyms; do not add skills the applicant does not possess.
- **Europass – Create your Europass CV** — https://europass.europa.eu/en/create-europass-cv
- **Germany Federal Employment Agency – Lebenslauf guidance** — https://www.arbeitsagentur.de/bildung/bewerbung/lebenslauf
- **Canada Job Bank – How to write a good resume** — https://www.on.jobbank.gc.ca/findajob/resources/write-good-resume
- **New Zealand Careers – How to write a CV** — https://knowyourcv.careers.govt.nz/job-hunting/cvs-and-cover-letters/how-to-write-a-cv/
- **Country comparison research used for initial market coverage** — https://www.snowresume.com/guides/best-resume-format-by-country
- **International CV conventions overview** — https://boostmyresume.org/en/blog/resume-format-by-country